

# Tecno Phantom V Flip

## Low-priced Foldable with Compromises

**A**fter Samsung, Motorola, and Oppo, Tecno has now also rolled out its first clamshell foldable smartphone. The brand launched the Tecno Phantom V Flip in India in October. The smartphone is the most affordable new generation foldable smartphone after the Moto Razr 40. One major thing that makes the Phantom V Flip's design different from other foldable smartphones is the outer display. Until now, we have seen squarish cover displays, rectangular cover displays, and even folder-shaped cover displays (from Samsung Galaxy Z Flip). Tecno, on the other hand, has featured a circular display in its foldable smartphone.

In this review, we will go through every component of the Tecno Phantom V Flip, which aims to make this form factor more accessible and hopefully give buyers something different to look at, if they are looking for a flip phone. So, here's my review of the Tecno Phantom V Flip.

### DESIGN

The Phantom V Flip comes in two colour options: Mystic Dawn and Iconic Black. I have used the Mystic Dawn variant and let me tell you this colour looks sweet. Mystic Dawn is basically a darker version of lilac, which is a new trend in smartphones. We have seen similar colours on the iPhone 14, then on the Galaxy Z Flip 5, and now on the Phantom V Flip.

Speaking of the design, it features a vegan leather back and a hole-punch foldable display, paired with an aluminium frame. Furthermore, the hinge is made of steel. The volume rockers and power buttons with fingerprint sensors are placed on the right side of the frame. It features two microphones, one at the bottom and one at the top. Next, the

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smartphone also comes with a stereo-speaker configuration.

Now coming to the main part, the outer display aka 'The Planet'. Do you know why Tecno calls it 'The Planet'? Well, it's because of its shape. The Tecno Phantom V Flip 5 features a circular display on the back, placed inside the circular bezel, which also is the camera module. However, I believe the bezel takes up a lot of unnecessary space, and it would have looked much better if it was slightly thinner. The outer display is a small 1.32-inch display and along with it, there are two cameras and an LED flashlight placed in the bezel.

The next major thing is the hinge and its functionalities. The closing sound of the smartphone is very satisfying. However, the hinge is a little loose. By "loose", I meant the smartphone is a little shaky. The next big drawback of the hinge is it does not open to a complete 180 degrees. In simple words, when you open it, you will see a very minor bend on the smartphone. Furthermore, you can hear or feel a minor movement in the hinge. Simply put, it is not as sturdy as it is supposed to be.

The grip is good, however, the inconvenience here is that the camera module has very thick bezels. So while grabbing the smartphone, you will always rest a finger or two on the module, leaving lots of smudges.

### DISPLAY

The Tecno Phantom V Flip is equipped with a 6.9-inch foldable AMOLED display that comes with a 1080 x 2640 pixels resolution. This display supports up to 120Hz refresh rate. However, in terms of vibrancy, it felt a little dull. We tested the brightness using a Lux Meter and the Tecno Phantom V Flip showed 803 nits of peak brightness.

The screen viewability under direct sunlight is surely not ideal.

In comparison, even mid-range smartphones offer brighter and more vivid displays.

Coming to the outer display, it features a

total of 10 widgets that you can use by swiping right. For example, I have set Weather Information, Time, Calendar, Camera, My Health App, and Alarm on the cover display. Moreover, it also offers four more widgets except for the ones I have mentioned. You can switch these apps with the existing ones. These four widgets are a Weather Alert, Timer, Stopwatch, and Sound Recorder. Apart from that, swiping right will take you to the media controls.

Further, you can also access quick settings by swiping down. Swiping up shows you fresh notifications, and you can also respond to them with emojis and basic replies like, "Okay, Hello, Thank You, etc". Lastly, you will also get to choose plenty of clock faces from Tecno's collection, pretty much like a smartwatch.

In conclusion, both the displays of the Tecno Phantom V Flip do pretty much all the things that its competition, the Moto Razr 40 can. However, the fun fact here is that you can also do all these things on a ₹3000 smartwatch.

